A COMPANION TO

The Practice Cards

THE QUIET BETWEEN THOUGHTS
MASTER KAION

HOW TO USE THESE

One page. One act. One night.

These are the practices I have given away one at a time, to the people who asked for them. Each one is a single act, done with the body, at a stated time. Not an idea to agree with. An act.

Do not read them all tonight. Open one page, do what it says, and close the book. A practice you performed once is worth more than thirty you understood.

The thirty days in the main book build on these. These stand alone if you have only tonight.

PRACTICE 01

Home

My friend, here is the full house blessing.

Open every window and let the old air leave. Walk through each room in silence, touch the walls, and say: from today, this space is a place of peace. Throw a handful of salt into the toilet and flush what is not yours. Then light one white candle in the center of your home and speak what you wish to live there: harmony, peace, rest. It is not the ritual that changes the house. It is the intention that changes you.

PRACTICE 02

Step

My friend, here is the first practice.

Tomorrow, before your mind can argue, put on your shoes and stand outside your door for two minutes. Do not go anywhere. Feel the air, the light, the sound. That is all. The day after, walk to the corner and back. You do not have to feel better to go out. You go out to feel better.

PRACTICE 03

Water

My friend, here is the ritual.

Tonight, fill a clear glass with water and place it beside your bed. As you set it down, say quietly: take from me what is not mine. Sleep. In the morning, do not drink it. Look at it once, then pour it away and say: it has done its work. Do this for three nights. The rest of what I know is inside The Quiet Between Thoughts. When you are ready, reply YES and I will leave you a small gift.

PRACTICE 04

Book

My friend, everything I teach is in one small book, The Quiet Between Thoughts.

Thirty days, ten minutes a day. It is below. Reply YES and I will leave you a small gift.

My friend, thank you for telling me where you watch from.

The path reaches farther than I imagined. Wherever you are, the practice is the same: begin small, begin today. Everything I know is inside The Quiet Between Thoughts. When you are ready, reply YES and I will leave you a small gift.

PRACTICE 06

I Am Learning

Good, my friend.

Today, catch one harsh sentence you say to yourself. Stop, and say it again the way you would say it to a child learning to walk. That is the whole practice.

PRACTICE 07

Tonight She Guards Me

Good, my friend.

Before sleep, sit on the edge of the bed, feet flat on the floor, three slow breaths, and say quietly: tonight I put it down. The body must hear the day is over.

PRACTICE 08

The Morning Is Mine

Then guard it, my friend.

Tonight the phone sleeps outside the bedroom. If it wakes you, it owns the morning before you have even opened your eyes.

PRACTICE 09

Enough

Good, my friend.

Tonight, one hour before sleep, let nothing new enter. No feed, no news, no one else's noise. The mind cannot put the day down while you keep handing it more.

PRACTICE 10

Peace

When it returns, my friend, do this.

Breathe in for four counts, out for six. Ten breaths. The longer exhale tells the body the danger has passed, and the mind follows the body.

PRACTICE 11

Amen

Good, my friend.

Tomorrow, before the phone, place one hand on your chest and say the line out loud, slowly, once. Words said with the body behind them work differently than words only thought.

PRACTICE 12

My Daughter

Do not wait for tonight, my friend.

Send her a voice message today. Three sentences, no occasion, your voice and not your typing. You will both remember it longer than any gift.

PRACTICE 13

Paths Are Opening

Good, my friend.

Each morning, touch the key once and name one door you want to open. One only. A person who names ten doors opens none.

PRACTICE 14

Abundance

Good, my friend.

Keep the seven grains for seven days. On the seventh day, take one grain out and give something small away, a coin, a coffee, a kind word. Abundance moves when it circulates.

PRACTICE 15

I Will Do It Today

Good, my friend.

Then one more thing for tomorrow. When you wake, before you touch your phone, drink a full glass of water slowly, standing by a window. The first thing you give your body sets the tone for the day.

PRACTICE 16

<Any Comment, All Posts>

Thank you for stopping here, my friend.

Here is something small to keep. Tonight, before you sleep, rest both hands over your eyes for the length of ten slow breaths. Let the dark be complete. The eyes carry the whole day, and they are the last part of you to stop working.

PRACTICE 17

Chao

I know that house, my friend.

Tonight, leave one small thing undone on purpose. One. A cup on the table, a door not straightened. Then sit down and let the room survive it, so your body can learn that nothing fell.

PRACTICE 18

Forgiv

Good, my friend.

Tonight, write one sentence on paper that begins: at the time, I did not know. Read it once in the morning, then tear the paper. The hand must finish what the mind keeps starting.